

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 6 3
 ♥ J 10 9 4
 ♦ K 5 3
 ♣ 10 7

♠ K Q 5

♥ A K 7

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 2

♥ 6 5 2

♦ 8 4

♣ A J 9 6 3

♠ 10 9 4

♥ Q 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

When you give up the lead the opponents are going to continue ♣s if they can. If East has a 5-card ♣ suit you could lose 3 ♣s, the ♠A and the ♦K. Either defender might win the ♠A, but only West can win with the ♦K.

Since East, the Danger hand, can only get in with the ♠A you should establish a ♠ winner first, even though the ♦s are better. Whoever wins the ♠A will probably knock out dummy's ♣K. Hopefully this will not cause you a problem because when your finesse for the ♦K loses to West he won't have another ♣. At least that's the Plan!

If you finesse in ♦s first, West will return his last ♣ and the suit will get established while East still has an entry in the ♠A.

Play ♠s first and even though East can win and establish ♣s West will not have a ♣ to return when he wins his ♦K.

It goes without saying that if your ♠K holds the trick you immediately switch to ♦s.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. With 17 points you bid the game.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♣6. You play the ♣4 from dummy, West plays the ♣10 and you take your ♣Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You are pretty sure East has the ♣A so dummy's ♣K can become a winner. If so, you only need 3 more winners.

All 3 can come from the ♦ suit if the finesse works, only 2 if it fails. Assume the worst, so that means you will also need a ♠ winner.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ K J 4
 ♦ K Q 6 3
 ♣ K 3 2

♠ 9 3

♥ 6 5 2

♦ J 10 4 2

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ K J 10

♥ A Q 7

♦ A 7 5

♣ A Q 7 4

♠ 8 7 6 4 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ 9 8

♣ 9 6

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by East

immediately test one, then the other.

In fact there is another possibility for success - even if neither suit is 3-3 it may be that the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits. In this case that defender can be squeezed. BUT, you don't play the ♣s and ♦s first, you play the other two suits.

Win the first ♥, then play two more ♥s and all three ♠ winners. That will be 6 tricks played, and each defender will be down to 7 cards left in their hand. If one of them happened to start with 4 ♣s and 4 ♦s he will have to discard from one of the holdings and you will be able to win your fourth card in that suit.

Although neither minor suit splits 3-3 it happens that North holds the guard in both suits.

When you play your sixth Major suit winner North is squeezed and must discard from one of his 4-card holdings.

This is an Automatic Squeeze, which just means you don't have to do any preparatory work. All you have to do is play off all your non-threat winners before you play the squeezing suits.

Partner has 20 or 21 points, balanced, and you have 18. You've always wanted to do this haven't you?

The contract would be 7NT played by West.

East plays 7NT. South leads the ♥10 and North follows with the ♥2.

DO NOT HOLD UP.

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 12

There are two chances for your thirteenth winner, your fourth ♣ or dummy's fourth ♦.

Some players will assume that means one of those two suits will have to split 3-3, so they will